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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Florida
Expected Completion: April 2027

M.A. in Economics, University of Florida, 2024

M.S. in Management, University of Florida, 2022

B.S. in Geophysics, Tongji University, Shanghai, China, 2021

DISSERTATION COMMITTEE

Prof. Eugenio Rojas (Co-Chair)
Department of Economics, University of Florida
erojasbarros@ufl.edu

Prof. Min Fang (Co-Chair)
China Europe International Business School
minfang@ceibs.edu

Prof. Jonathan Adams
Federal Reserve Bank of Kansas City
Jonathan.X.Adams@kc.frb.org

RESEARCH AND TEACHING FIELDS

Primary fields: Macroeconomics, Monetary Economics
Secondary field: Innovation and Firm Dynamics

JOB MARKET PAPER

Monetary Policy and Firm Innovation
[Latest version] [SSRN 5137261]
JEL codes: E52, O31, O32, O34

This paper studies how monetary policy shapes firm-level innovation, using linked Compustat, USPTO, and CRSP data with local projection methods. The R&D response to monetary policy operates almost entirely through the intensive margin: expansionary shocks raise R&D and knowledge capital among firms already engaged in innovation, while other firms remain largely unresponsive. On the output side, expansionary shocks lower the aggregate number of patents but raise average citations and, over the medium run, patent importance and the share of patents in the upper tail of the importance distribution, consistent with firms reallocating R&D from incremental patenting toward higher-impact projects as financing conditions ease. A two-stage analysis indicates that this reallocation operates through the R&D response itself rather than through a direct effect of the shock on patenting. The effects are also asymmetric in sign: contractionary shocks reduce both the quantity and quality of innovation, and this reallocation-toward-quality channel is cleanest among economically large shocks. Monetary policy therefore changes the direction of firms' innovation as well as its scale.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Artificial Intelligence and Inventory Management: Evidence from U.S. Retail Industry
with Shuang Chen, Min Fang, Boyuan Li and Baolian Wang. Draft available.

Inventory is a hedge against forecast error, and AI is a prediction technology, so AI adoption should show up on firms' balance sheets. We build function-level measures of AI adoption for more than 1,300 U.S. public firms from the near-universe of U.S. online job postings (Lightcast, 2010–2023), flagging AI vacancies by their machine-learning skill content and classifying them into marketing and supply-chain functions with a tiered keyword taxonomy, and link them to Compustat working-capital outcomes. In long-difference regressions on 689 firms, rising AI adoption compresses retailers' cash conversion cycle, by about a week of receivables per standard deviation of supply-chain AI, and the compression runs through receivables rather than inventory. In an event study around the 2018 U.S.–China tariff announcements, China-exposed retailers with more supply-chain AI lost significantly less market value, an effect that builds over 40 to 80 trading days and is absent for marketing AI.

Solving the Macro and Micro Investment Elasticity Inconsistency with Incomplete Information
with Jonathan Adams, Min Fang and Eugenio Rojas. Draft in progress, first version April 2025.

Heterogeneous-firm investment models cannot match the macro investment elasticity, the sensitivity of aggregate investment to the real interest rate, and the micro elasticity, how firms switch between the extensive and intensive margins of investment, at the same time. Fixed costs small enough to fit micro data (Cooper and Haltiwanger, 2006; Khan and Thomas, 2008) leave the macro elasticity too large, and fixed costs large enough to fit the macro elasticity (Winberry, 2021; Koby and Wolf, 2020) distort the micro margins. We build a heterogeneous-firm model with fixed, partially irreversible and quadratic adjustment costs in which firms observe only a noisy signal of their own productivity, solve it by value function iteration, and show that incomplete information dampens both elasticities and narrows, and can close, the gap between them.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, University of Florida

ECO 4213 Monetary Economics · Undergraduate
Fall 2025, Fall 2026

Student evaluation 4.27 out of 5 in Fall 2025, against department and college means of 4.14.

Teaching Assistant, University of Florida

ECO 3713 International Macroeconomics · Undergraduate
Summer 2026

ECO 5427 Econometric Analysis 2 · Master's
Spring 2026

ECP 3703 Managerial Economics · Undergraduate
Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2023, Spring 2026

ECO 6936 Special Topics · Master's
Fall 2024

ECO 3203 Intermediate Macroeconomics · Undergraduate
Spring 2024

ECO 5207 Macroeconomic Analysis · Master's

Spring 2024

ECO 7115 Microeconomic Theory · Ph.D.
Fall 2023

ECP 5702 Managerial Economics · Master's
Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2023

ECO 3101 Intermediate Microeconomics · Undergraduate
Summer 2023

ECO 6409 Game Theory Applied · MBA
Spring 2023

RELEVANT POSITIONS

2020–21 Administrative and HR Assistant, Shanghai Potomer International Trade Co., Ltd., Shanghai

COMPUTER SKILLS

Stata, Python, R, Julia, Matlab, SQL, LaTeX

LANGUAGES

Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent)